

Caddy

Caddy is an easy-to-use web server with automatic HTTPS configuration, making it particularly appealing for developers looking for a simple and secure solution.

Market share: Caddy is gaining traction but still holds a relatively small market share of around 5%.

Main Features	
Automatic HTTPS	Built-in HTTPS support with automatic certificate renewal.
Easy configuration	Simple configuration with default settings that work out-of-the-box.
HTTP/2 support	Supports HTTP/2 for faster communication.
Extensible	Caddy offers various plugins for extended functionality.

Ideal use cases

- *Small to medium websites:* Especially useful for developers seeking simplicity.
- *Secure websites:* Websites that need automatic SSL/TLS configuration.
- *Quick prototyping:* Great for rapid development and testing of web apps.

LiteSpeed

LiteSpeed is a high-performance web server known for handling dynamic content efficiently. It is often favoured by shared hosting providers for its robust performance and security.

Market share: LiteSpeed's market share is growing, particularly in the shared hosting industry, and stands at around 6-7%.

Main Features	
High speed and scalability	Offers exceptional speed with a high connection limit.
HTTP/3 and QUIC support	Supports HTTP/3 and QUIC protocols for faster connections.
Built-in caching	Native caching to improve content delivery performance.
Security features	DDoS protection, mod_security, and more for enhanced security.

Ideal use cases

- *Content-heavy websites:* Sites that need quick delivery of dynamic content (e.g., WordPress sites).
- *Shared hosting:* Popular for use in shared hosting environments.
- *E-commerce sites:* Due to its performance optimisation and security features.

OpenResty

OpenResty is a dynamic web platform based on NGINX, which extends its capabilities with Lua scripting. It is particularly suited for building web applications, including microservices.

Market share: OpenResty holds a smaller market share (around 2%), and is primarily used in specialised scenarios.

Main Features	
Lua scripting support	Extends NGINX with Lua to create custom web solutions.
High concurrency	Designed for high concurrency, especially for APIs and microservices.
Integration with databases	Easily integrates with databases for building dynamic applications.
Web application gateway	Can serve as an API gateway, providing advanced routing and control.

Ideal use cases

- *Microservices:* Suitable for building and managing API-driven microservices.
- *Real-time applications:* Great for real-time apps requiring high concurrency.
- *Custom web apps:* Ideal when building custom, high-performance web applications.

Tomcat

Tomcat is a Java-based web server and servlet container designed to execute Java Servlets and JavaServer Pages (JSP). It's widely used for Java-based web applications.

Market share: Tomcat has a significant presence in the Java ecosystem, holding around 4-5% of the market share.

Main Features	
Java Servlet and JSP support	Natively supports Java Servlet API and JSP for dynamic content generation.
Scalability	Suitable for large-scale Java-based enterprise applications.
Security and integration	Advanced security features and integration with Java EE applications.
Clustering and load balancing	Supports clustering for high availability and distributed systems.

Ideal use cases

- *Enterprise Java applications:* Excellent for hosting Java-based web apps.
- *Java developers:* Ideal for developers working within the Java ecosystem.
- *Scalable systems:* Suitable for systems requiring load balancing and clustering.